HACK876 × DIGICEL FOUNDATION

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Every child deserves a turn at building the future.

The Digicel Foundation believes every child deserves access to technology and the future it brings. Hack876 gives students one day to take that technology and build something of their own.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers

WHY THE DIGICEL FOUNDATION

The Digicel Foundation puts technology into schools under its To Build Minds goal, and runs its own Girls in ICT hackathons.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

A Platinum contribution toward the inaugural event, or any level that suits the Foundation this year.

Platinum Partner: J$1,000,000+. Any amount within the level is welcome.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Helps support the equipment teams build with, the prizes, and the running of the day.

WHAT THE DIGICEL FOUNDATION RECEIVES

About 80 secondary-school students spend a full day using technology to build a working prototype. The Foundation receives Platinum recognition and a written recap of who took part and what they built.

THE NEXT STEP

A conversation about whether the Foundation would consider supporting the inaugural event, directly or through one of its grant calls. A detailed budget will follow before any formal commitment.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com



You open the lab doors. We give students a reason to stay and build.

Hack876 is a place where that access turns into something a student made with their own hands.

DIGICEL FOUNDATION MISSION

"We aim to mobilise and distribute resources across Jamaican communities to improve education at the early childhood, primary, secondary, and tertiary levels, increase access and opportunities for persons with special needs, and stimulate sustainable entrepreneurial activity."[1]

One of the Foundation's goals is To Build Minds: improving literacy and access to technology in schools across Jamaica.[1]

Its Girls in ICT work aims to narrow the technology gender gap. In May 2026 it hosted a full-day AI hackathon for girls from Denham Town and Tivoli Gardens high schools.[2]

In April 2026 it sponsored an AI hackathon for secondary-school girls across western Jamaica, themed AI for Development: Girls Shaping the Digital Future.[3]

THE RECORD

SINCE 2004

US$51.6 million. 1,750 projects.

Invested across education, community development and special needs, with 889,381 lives impacted.[1]

SMART LABS

28 labs and counting.

Smart Labs established in schools and institutions, alongside 34,030 students reached through the Safer Internet Together programme.[1]

2025 TO 2026

Labs for the people who teach.

Five Smart Labs at teacher training colleges and four in special-needs institutions, plus more than 100 young Jamaicans in a digital technology and coding programme.[6]

GIRLS IN ICT · 2026

A full day of AI, built by girls.

Girls from Denham Town and Tivoli Gardens high schools spent a day applying AI to climate challenges, mentored by engineer and board director Antoinette Heirs.[2]

02 OUR REQUEST

Become a Platinum Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$1,000,000+ PLATINUM PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

Platinum is flexible: it helps support prizes, meals and the day itself in one gift. If a smaller gift fits the Foundation better this year, a contribution at any level is welcome.

WHAT IT HELPS SUPPORT

- **The event overall.** Used where it helps the students most.
- **Prizes.** Contributes toward the prizes for the top teams.
- **Equipment.** Helps support the equipment teams build with.
- **Event production.** Helps support staging, sound and the room.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

A detailed event budget will follow before any formal commitment is asked for.

WHAT THE DIGICEL FOUNDATION WOULD RECEIVE

- **Everything in Gold**
- **The most prominent placement on the website and event signage**
- **A written recap after the event**

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner	Platinum Partner SUGGESTED
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

A first-year event, with the essentials in place.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.
THE DAY	One day, 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM: an opening, a build period with mentors, judging, finals and awards.

SCHOOL NETWORK AND STATUS

Hillel Academy	CONFIRMED
Campion College	CONFIRMED
Jamaica College	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Immaculate Conception High School	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Wolmer's	NOT YET CONFIRMED
Ardenne High School	IN TALKS
American International School of Kingston	NOT YET CONFIRMED
St. Andrew High School for Girls	NOT YET CONFIRMED
St. George's College	NOT YET CONFIRMED

2 confirmed, 1 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed. This is the network where the Hack876 team has relationships. It is not a list of confirmed participants, and it is not an exclusive eligibility list.

SAFEGUARDS. MANY PARTICIPANTS ARE MINORS.

Sponsors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day.

Mentors and volunteers work in open, supervised spaces.

Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship carries no influence over judging and no naming rights.

What you would see afterwards, and what we need from you now.

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ How many students, teams and schools took part
- ✓ What the teams built, with the finalist projects described
- ✓ How your contribution was used
- ✓ Photos, only where schools and parents have consented

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

POSSIBLE LATER, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

Teams from Smart Lab schools joining Hack876 as it grows.

Safer Internet Together sessions in participating schools before the day.

A signpost from Hack876 to the Foundation's own girls' AI hackathons and STEM camps.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A conversation about whether the Foundation would consider supporting the inaugural event, directly or through one of its grant calls. A detailed budget will follow before any formal commitment.

The Foundation's formal grant calls open in set windows for community groups, schools and non-profits. We are asking directly because Hack876 is a single day, but we are happy to follow whichever route suits the Foundation.[8]

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

We would love to explore the right first step with Charmaine and the Digicel Foundation team.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No phones, SIMs, data plans or other Digicel products or offers are marketed to students. Many participants are minors.

No student data, phone numbers or contact details are collected or shared for the Foundation or Digicel. Any recap uses group numbers and school-approved photos only.

Volunteers, mentors and judges work in open, supervised spaces.

Contribution levels, and what each receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement on the website and event signage
- A dedicated sponsor feature**
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Gold
- The most prominent placement on the website and event signage

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

**The form of the sponsor feature is agreed with each Gold or Platinum partner before it is confirmed.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

In-kind & Community Support: For contributions in kind, and for contributions below J$50,000. A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

SOURCES

1. Digicel Foundation, "About the Digicel Foundation." www.digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/about

2. Jamaica Observer, "Digicel Foundation empowers Denham Town and Tivoli High girls with AI skills (May 23, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/05/23/digicel-foundation-empowers-denham-town-tivoli-high-girls-ai-skills/

3. Jamaica Gleaner, "Montego Bay High wins hackathon (April 25, 2026)." jamaica-gleaner.com/article/news/20260425/montego-bay-high-wins-hackathon-hurricane-response-app

4. Digicel Foundation, "Smart Lab at the NAZ Children Centre (June 23, 2025)." www.digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/news/digicel-foundation-boosts-digital-literacy-for-special-needs-with-new-smart-lab-at-naz-children-centre

5. Digicel Foundation, "Digicel Foundation Equips Teachers' Colleges with State-of-the-Art Smart Labs (October 12, 2025)." www.digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/news/digicel-foundation-equips-teachers-colleges-with-smart-labs

6. Jamaica Observer, "Digicel Foundation touching more lives (October 6, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/10/06/digicel-foundation-touching-lives/

7. Digicel Foundation, "Digicel Foundation Highlights STEM & Special Needs in Camps (August 13, 2025)." www.digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/news/digicel-foundation-puts-stem-education-and-special-needs-in-focus-through-summer-camps

8. Digicel Foundation, "Salute 21 Grants Campaign (August 2, 2025)." www.digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/news/digicel-foundation-targets-digital-literacy-and-silver-economy-in-new-salute-21-grants-campaign

A private partnership proposal prepared for Charmaine Daniels, Chief Executive Officer, Digicel Foundation.